participation. For both them and us, it is a mistake. At this moment of truth for the country, tactical considerations should not stand in the way of basic moral principles and, mainly, for those who do not want to hear about moral principles, such considerations should not hide catastrophic practical consequences.

I do not know whether the conflict with the Palestinians can still find a peaceful solution; nobody knows. Maybe it never could, from the very beginning of Zionism. But there is no doubt that the continuing domination of the Occupied Territories and constant expansion of settlements fans the flames of conflict. And the brutality of our operations in the territories not only exacerbates Palestinian violence, but increasingly brutalizes our own society. Very few of us are ready to recognize that the fight for democracy is inseparable from the recognition of equality of treatment for Arab and Jewish citizens in Israel and an end to the domination over Palestinians beyond our borders. And, in immediate and concrete terms, there is much more.

If the judicial overhaul gets through, a Knesset majority will be capable not only of cleansing Netanyahu and Deri of all wrong-doing but of resolving on the annexation of the West Bank. I know that this is not said aloud these days, and seems to have been forgotten out of fear of international, particularly American, reactions. But didn’t the Aqaba decisions mention a moratorium on settlements of only six months? Do you think that, once the six months have elapsed, Ben-Gvir and Smotrich will let it go? As with all nationalist-religious zealots, they will never abandon one of their major goals. Once they have their way, there will be many more Elon Morehs, to paraphrase Menachem Begin, but also many more Huwaras, and, why not, many more Deir Yassins. And, all at once, Israel, as everybody here knows it and loves it, will have disappeared, to be replaced by an authentic and criminal apartheid state.